

May

11

Setting a record

Amateur French cyclist Henri Desgrange covered 35.325 km (21.950 miles) in one hour at the Vélodrome Buffalo cycling track in Paris, France, setting the first hour record in cycling.



1893

330 CE

Founding Constantinople

A new capital for the Roman Empire was established by Emperor Constantine at the city of Byzantium. It was renamed Constantinople after its founder. Today it is the city of Istanbul in Turkey.



Born this day

1904 Salvador Dalí, Spanish artist. He was known for his surrealist style, which made use of unusual, dreamlike imagery.

1906 Jacqueline Cochran, US racing pilot. She was the first woman to fly faster than the speed of sound.

Also on this day

1846 Following a border dispute between the USA and Mexico, US president James K Polk asked Congress to declare war on Mexico.

2000 According to official records, the population of India reached 1 billion people.

2019 Scientists at Mauna Loa Observatory in Hawaii announced that the carbon dioxide level in Earth's atmosphere had reached levels not seen for 300 million years.

868

Diamond Sutra

The oldest printed book in existence was created in ancient China. The sacred Buddhist text was discovered in a hidden cave near Dunhuang, China, in 1900.

